

something we need to enjoy. You can't help the pressure, so when you enjoy the feeling, it helps a lot. I genuinely don't have long-term plans. I don't think that far ahead. I enjoy the moment.

Treesa: I don't even know what's going to happen tomorrow! I think at this age, we just need to enjoy and play as much as we can and gain as much experience as we can. There's no extra pressure. If I feel extra pressure, she (Gayatri) will make me relax. She comes and talks to me in a very cool and calm way.

You seem to get along well! Do you hang out together a lot?

Treesa: We do. I think when we go for tournaments, we might go shopping. We also like roaming around the mall. I think Gaya makes us go out. She loves to go out.

Gayatri: I can't sit in the room. I can't sit there and do nothing. Whereas she likes to sleep!

Has there ever been a time when you guys didn't agree on something?

Treesa: Of course, sometimes we do get into a disagreement. It's not an argument or anything. But there are moments where there is a doubt about who goes to the shuttle.

Gayatri: When one is not in form, the other is always there to help. When I'm not playing well, she's there to guide me and be solid in that position.

Gayatri was coming back from an injury towards the end of last season. How hard was it for both you and Treesa to bounce back from it?

Gayatri: This isn't the worst injury I've had. I think you have to realise that every time you get an injury, you have a chance to recover and work on areas where there is some sort of pain. I've been able to do that. I think right now I'm feeling pretty good and fit.

Treesa: When Gayatri was dealing with this, I was waiting for her to come back to court soon. I was just practising. She feels that I need her, and it's true. We all have gone

through bad situations (injury), and she also feels I need to get back on court as well. I place her at 100 per cent fit. She is fully fit now!

You train together at probably the best badminton academy in India. You have the likes of Satwik Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty training alongside you. What do you pick up from them?

Gayatri: The one thing I noticed is that the seniors come to training sessions an hour ahead of everyone else. They do a lot of small strengthening exercises. I didn't use to do it before, but that's something I'm incorporating as well. Those are the sort of little things that I try to do.

Treesa: We, of course, see how Chirag and Satwik are playing. They have been the world number one too. We can learn from the confidence with which they play, but as Gayatri said, it's not just learning from what they are doing on the court; it's also about what they are doing before practice. Those are the small things you need to pick up.

What have you learned from your past year?

Treesa: We learn a lot when we lose matches. I think very early in our career, there was this understanding that we needed to be sharp after 15 points. Compared to us, the other players were playing more safely. We need to be more careful while playing in that last part of the match. I think we learned this very early on — that we need to change these things. Of course, once we understand where we are making mistakes, we need to get more confident about what we are doing.

Where's an area where you think you could get better?

Gayatri: There's a lot of room for improvement. We are playing the top 10 players in the world, and I'm confident we can give them a good fight and beat them. But in general, both physically and mentally, there's a lot of work to be done. The mental part of the game is crucial, especially towards the end of the game. It's still a place where we need to work.

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